

Page 1: Purpose, Scope, and Leave Basics

BrightPath Office Services maintains this fictional policy so employees and managers can handle common leave and reimbursement questions consistently. The policy applies to full-time and part-time office staff after their first 30 calendar days of employment. Contractors may use the reimbursement rules when a written statement of work allows business expense repayment, but they do not receive paid leave.

Annual leave is provided for rest, personal travel, family events, and other planned time away from work. Full-time employees receive 18 working days of annual leave each calendar year. Part-time employees receive annual leave in proportion to their normal weekly schedule. Unused annual leave may be carried forward up to 5 working days into the next calendar year. Any annual leave above the 5-day carry-forward limit expires on December 31 unless Human Resources approves an exception in writing.

Employees should request planned annual leave at least 10 working days before the first day away. Requests are submitted to the direct manager by email or through the office scheduling tool. Managers should respond within 3 working days and should consider team coverage, client commitments, and fairness to other employees. Approved leave is not considered final until it appears on the shared team calendar.

Sick leave is available when an employee is ill, recovering from treatment, attending an urgent medical appointment, or caring for an immediate family member. Employees should notify their manager as early as possible on the first day of absence. A medical note may be requested when sick leave continues for more than 3 consecutive working days.

Page 2: Special Leave and Remote Work During Absence

Employees may request up to 5 paid bereavement leave days after the death of an immediate family member. Immediate family includes a spouse or partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, grandchild, or a person who lives in the employee's household. Managers may approve additional unpaid leave when travel or ceremony dates require more time.

Emergency personal leave may be used for unexpected events such as a home repair crisis, school closure, legal appointment, or urgent family need. Emergency personal leave is limited to 3 paid working days per calendar year. Employees should contact their manager by phone or message before the workday begins whenever possible.

Public holidays announced by the company are paid non-working days. If a client deadline requires an employee to work on a public holiday, the manager must approve the work in advance. The employee may then take one replacement day within 60 calendar days.

Remote work is not a substitute for approved leave. An employee who is too unwell to work should use sick leave rather than working remotely. However, a manager may approve remote work for part of a day when the employee can complete duties safely and the arrangement does not disrupt meetings, customer service, or confidential information handling.

Page 3: Reimbursement Eligibility and Limits

Business expenses are reimbursed when they are necessary, reasonable, documented, and approved by the correct manager. Eligible expenses include local travel to client meetings, economy rail or air travel approved in advance, modest working meals during approved travel, printing for client materials, and office supplies purchased for a specific team need.

Employees must choose practical, cost-conscious options. Taxi or ride-share expenses are reimbursed when public transportation is unavailable, unsafe, or would cause a significant delay. Personal vehicle mileage is reimbursed at the monthly rate published by Finance. Alcohol, entertainment, fines, personal clothing, personal subscriptions, and upgrades to premium travel are not reimbursable.

Meal reimbursement during approved travel is capped at 800 INR for breakfast, 1,200 INR for lunch, and 1,500 INR for dinner. When a hotel or event provides a meal, the employee should not claim a second meal for the same period. Tips may be reimbursed only when they are customary and included on the receipt.

Receipts are required for every reimbursement claim above 500 INR. A receipt must show the vendor, date, amount, and purchased item or service. If a receipt is lost, the employee must submit a written explanation and manager approval. Finance may reject claims that do not contain enough detail to confirm the business purpose.

Page 4: Claim Submission, Approval, and Exceptions

Reimbursement claims must be submitted within 15 calendar days after the expense date. Claims are submitted with receipts attached and a short business purpose for each line item. Travel claims should include the client name, meeting date, and destination. Late claims may be denied unless the employee explains the delay and Finance approves the exception.

The direct manager approves ordinary expenses up to 10,000 INR. Department heads approve claims above 10,000 INR or any claim involving overnight travel. Finance gives final payment approval after checking receipts, policy limits, and budget coding. Employees should not approve their own expenses or ask a peer to approve expenses on their behalf.

Approved reimbursements are normally paid in the next payroll cycle. If a claim is missing information, Finance will return it for correction within 5 working days. Employees should keep original receipts until reimbursement appears in payroll.

Policy exceptions must be documented before the expense is incurred whenever possible. Emergency exceptions may be reviewed afterward, but approval is not guaranteed. Human Resources owns leave policy interpretation, Finance owns reimbursement interpretation, and the Office Manager maintains the current published copy of this policy.